more likely to uphold the status quo. Ironically, one student from KP studying in a madrassa in Islamabad quotes Muhammad Ali Jinnah to make a case for why he is not politically active: '*Work, work and work – Quaid-e-Azam. And I am a full time student*' (Madrassa Student, Male, Islamabad). In the sample only 5 per cent of the participants provided an exception to the general narrative, and these were young people from either ethnic minorities or the Shi'a population, with very few allies across the student body.

Furthermore, in Pakistan today there is an active attempt by the security state to thwart any possibility of political activity by young Pakistanis, especially on university campuses. The Pakistani state ever since its inception has had a troubled relationship with student activism, despite the active role of students in the independence struggle. The history of student activism post independence is marred with episodes of violence that led to student unions being banned (see Mullick 2008; Paracha 2000). This ban is part of the reason that today young people do not identify with politics. Since the majority of the Pakistani youth who are now of voting age were born in the 1980s or later, they would not have experienced student politics and seen the link between student and national politics (Jinnah Institute 2013), except for the occasional ethnic-based campus violence often led by the Jamiat.

However, as we will establish in Chapter 3 the education system in Pakistan inculcates values of discipline to the point of curtailing any form of critical reflection or questioning by the students. It was therefore not surprising to find that the majority of the young people in this study were either apolitical or antipolitical. Even academics in universities and school teachers described any form of politics as being unworthy and corrupt.

The Pakistani government is aware of the youth's apathy. The report published by the Centre of Civic Education (CCE) (2009) makes a number of suggestions to improve political participation by the youth. They include first that students' unions need to serve as a training ground for young people to learn the art of politics by working on solutions to academic and administrative problems on campuses. While student politics on campus is not meant to engage in national politics, political parties have a responsibility to engage the students through their youth wings and should device a strategy to build their confidence in political institutions.[44] The report also addresses the fact that politicians should lead by example and as public figures should be seen as serving the nation rather than for their personal gain. In this way the report hopes the image of politics could be improved. Yet it is clear from the data collected and the preceding discussion that young people are not getting involved in politics for a number of